

HISTORY

GRADE 12 HISTORY TERM 3 CONTROLLED EXAMINATION

SUBJECT	HISTORY
GRADE	12
ASSESSMENT TASK	GRADE 12 HISTORY TERM 3 CONTROLLED EXAMINATION
MARKS	125
TIME	3 hours

Educator approval required before classroom use.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. Read all instructions carefully.
2. Answer all questions or complete all activities as instructed.
3. Show all working where calculations, planning, diagrams or explanations are required.
4. Use the space provided by the educator, answer booklet or learner task book.
5. Write neatly and clearly.

EVIDENCE / STIMULUS MATERIAL

SOURCE 1A: Opening statement at a multiparty negotiation forum, 1991

Type: constructed political statement | Provenance: Constructed synthesis based on themes documented in the CODESA negotiation process; not a verbatim quotation. | Date: 1991 | Context: A constructed negotiation-era statement for source analysis.

Delegates from political organisations and administrations have gathered after decades of conflict and exclusion. Although they represent different traditions, they share two immediate purposes: ending apartheid and creating a democratic state based on the will of the people. The path to negotiations has involved repression, protest and loss of life. A negotiated settlement is presented as the only workable route forward. The statement warns that political violence and groups opposed to majority rule may derail the process. It nevertheless commits the forum to a unitary, non-racial and non-sexist South Africa, a justiciable Bill of Rights, and a constitution that protects human dignity. Delegates are urged to negotiate in good faith because millions of South Africans depend on a peaceful settlement.

SOURCE 1B: Election observer's field note, Soweto, 27 April 1994

Type: constructed contemporary observation | Provenance: Constructed eyewitness-style record based on widely documented features of South Africa's first democratic election. | Date: 27 April 1994 | Context: A constructed observation record with an explicit limitation.

Before sunrise, a long queue had formed outside the polling station. Most voters were Black South Africans who had never previously been permitted to vote in a national election. Elderly voters waited beside young adults, while some parents carried children and identity documents. IEC officials directed the queue and explained the ballot procedure. Despite the long wait, the atmosphere remained patient and celebratory. Several voters described the act of placing a ballot in the box as proof that citizenship now included them. The note records only one polling station and therefore cannot represent every experience of the election, but it captures the determination visible at that location.

SOURCE 1C: A former negotiation delegate reflects on the road to the 1994 election

Type: constructed retrospective account | Provenance: Constructed retrospective account for classroom analysis; the speaker is fictional and the passage is not taken from a memoir. | Date: Written retrospectively | Context: A constructed retrospective source that learners can evaluate for perspective and hindsight.

The April 1994 election fulfilled a goal that many South Africans had pursued for decades: equal political citizenship. The negotiations were repeatedly threatened by mistrust and violence. The assassination of Chris Hani in April 1993 created a real danger that anger would overwhelm the talks, but it also increased pressure on political leaders to set an election date and prevent further conflict. Compromise was unavoidable. The liberation movements accepted a phased transition and a Government of National Unity, while the outgoing government accepted majority rule and a binding Bill of Rights. Looking back, the delegate describes the election as both a victory over apartheid and the product of difficult concessions. Because the account was written after the successful election, its hopeful tone may understate divisions that remained unresolved.

SOURCE 2A: Soviet foreign-policy statement reflecting the 'new thinking' of 1988

Type: constructed policy statement | Provenance: Constructed paraphrase of themes associated with Gorbachev's 1988 United Nations address; not a verbatim quotation. | Date: 1988 | Context: A constructed policy source illustrating Gorbachev's shift away from coercive control.

International relations can no longer depend on the threat or use of force. Every nation must be allowed to choose its own political path without external coercion. The Soviet Union will retain its own values, but it should not impose them on other states. Foreign policy must become less ideological, and disputes should be addressed through cooperation and negotiation. This approach implies that Soviet military power will no longer automatically preserve communist governments in Eastern Europe.

SOURCE 2B: Editorial response to the opening of the Berlin Wall, November 1989

Type: constructed contemporary editorial | Provenance: Constructed newspaper-style commentary for classroom analysis; not reproduced from a published editorial. | Date: November 1989 | Context: A constructed editorial interpretation written from the perspective of November 1989.

Crowds crossing the Berlin Wall have done more than open a border. They have exposed the weakening of Soviet influence throughout Eastern Europe. Moscow did not send tanks to preserve the East German government, as it had used force against earlier challenges in the region. Popular pressure, reform movements and the Soviet policy of non-intervention have combined to make the old division of Europe unsustainable. The celebration in Berlin is therefore also a warning to every government that relies on outside power rather than public consent.

SOURCE 2C: Interpreting the end of the Cold War and its significance for South Africa

Type: constructed secondary interpretation | Provenance: Constructed secondary synthesis for educator review; not a quotation from a published historian. | Date: Contemporary synthesis | Context: A constructed interpretation that presents multiple causes and avoids a single-factor explanation.

Gorbachev's reforms were intended to renew the Soviet system, yet glasnost and perestroika widened criticism and weakened central control. In Poland, Solidarity demonstrated the organisational strength of popular resistance, while economic stagnation limited Moscow's ability to sustain its allies. The revolutions of 1989 and the collapse of the Soviet Union therefore resulted from both reform from above and pressure from below. For South Africa, the decline of superpower rivalry weakened the apartheid government's claim that racial rule was necessary to resist communism. It also reduced external support for armed conflict in the region and created a more favourable climate for negotiations, although internal mass resistance and economic pressure remained essential causes of political change.

SOURCE 3A: Summary of a survivor's testimony to the Truth and Reconciliation Commission

Type: constructed testimony summary | Provenance: Constructed composite based on recurring forms of TRC testimony; no words are attributed to a real witness. | Date: TRC hearing period, 1996-1998 | Context: A constructed composite testimony for evaluating value and limitation.

A survivor describes being detained without trial during the 1980s and assaulted while officials demanded information about local activists. The testimony identifies the place of detention, the methods used and the lasting effect on the survivor's family. Speaking publicly is described as painful but necessary because the abuse had previously been denied. The survivor wants official acknowledgement and information about who authorised the operation. The account provides a personal perspective and detailed memory, but trauma, elapsed time and the survivor's limited access to official records must be considered when historians corroborate particular details.

SOURCE 3B: A historian assesses the TRC as evidence and as a process of reconciliation

Type: constructed historian's interpretation | Provenance: Constructed secondary interpretation for classroom use; not a quotation from a published historian. | Date: Contemporary synthesis | Context: A constructed balanced interpretation of the TRC's historical value and limits.

The TRC created an unusually large public archive of testimony about apartheid-era violations and made experiences that had been excluded from official records visible. Its hearings helped some families obtain acknowledgement and allowed historians to compare personal accounts with institutional documents. Yet the archive is incomplete. Not every victim testified, perpetrators seeking amnesty had incentives to shape their accounts, and the focus on gross human-rights violations could obscure the everyday structural effects of apartheid. The TRC therefore remains indispensable evidence, but it cannot by itself provide a complete history or prove that reconciliation was achieved equally for all communities.

QUESTIONS

QUESTION 1: THE COMING OF DEMOCRACY IN SOUTH AFRICA

Instructions: Use Sources 1A to 1C and your own knowledge where required.

Stimulus: Refer to SOURCE 1A, SOURCE 1B and SOURCE 1C.

1.1. According to Source 1A, state TWO purposes that brought delegates to the negotiation forum. **(2)**

1.2. Identify THREE details in Source 1B that show the inclusive and determined character of the election. **(3)**

1.3. Explain why the assassination of Chris Hani was both a threat to and a catalyst for the negotiation process. **(3)**

1.4. Explain how Source 1C supports Source 1A's warning that negotiations faced serious difficulties. **(4)**

1.5. Evaluate the usefulness of Source 1B for a historian studying public participation on 27 April 1994. **(4)**

1.6. Explain TWO ways in which hindsight may influence the perspective in Source 1C. **(4)**

1.7. Using all three sources and your own knowledge, assess the extent to which the 1994 election resulted from political compromise. (5)

QUESTION 2: THE END OF THE COLD WAR AND A NEW WORLD ORDER

Instructions: Use Sources 2A to 2C and your own knowledge where required.

Stimulus: Refer to SOURCE 2A, SOURCE 2B and SOURCE 2C.

2.1. State TWO principles of the Soviet 'new thinking' described in Source 2A. (2)

2.2. What does Source 2B identify as the significance of Moscow's decision not to send tanks to East Germany? (2)

2.3. State TWO consequences of the end of superpower rivalry for South Africa. (2)

2.4. Explain how Source 2A reflects a change in Soviet foreign policy. (3)

2.5. Explain why the opening of the Berlin Wall represented more than a change to one national border. (3)

2.6. Evaluate the reliability of Source 2C as an explanation of the end of the Cold War. (4)

2.7. Compare how Sources 2A and 2B explain the decline of Soviet control in Eastern Europe. (4)

2.8. Using all three sources and your own knowledge, assess the extent to which Gorbachev's reforms caused the end of the Cold War. (5)

QUESTION 3: THE TRUTH AND RECONCILIATION COMMISSION

Instructions: Use Sources 3A and 3B to conduct a historical enquiry into testimony, evidence and reconciliation.

Stimulus: Refer to SOURCE 3A and SOURCE 3B.

3.1. State TWO reasons why the survivor considered public testimony necessary. (2)

3.2. Explain what Source 3A reveals about both the value and the difficulty of survivor testimony. (4)

3.3. Compare the views of Sources 3A and 3B on the historical value of testimony. (4)

3.4. Evaluate the usefulness and limitations of Source 3B for a historian assessing the TRC. (5)

3.5. Write a historical paragraph assessing the extent to which the TRC produced both truth and reconciliation. (10)

QUESTION 4: EXTENDED WRITING

Instructions: Write a well-structured historical essay with a clear line of argument and relevant evidence.

Stimulus: The late 1980s witnessed transformative changes globally. In the Soviet Union, Mikhail Gorbachev introduced policies of glasnost (openness) and perestroika (restructuring), which had profound effects on Soviet foreign policy and Eastern Europe. Simultaneously, events such as the fall of the Berlin Wall and the revolutions of 1989 reshaped the international order. In Southern Africa, these developments occurred alongside internal pressures against apartheid. This question invites you to analyse the interconnectedness of these global and regional developments.

4.1. Evaluate the extent to which Gorbachev's reforms (glasnost and perestroika) and the events in Eastern Europe in 1989 contributed to the end of the Cold War and accelerated political change in South Africa. Support your argument with relevant historical evidence. (50)
